

— DEAL AGREED • MEDICAL PENDING

HE PICKED
UNITED.

SPURS. NOT

Mateus Fernandes' £85m move, broken down.

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 06

| HE PICKED SPURS. NOT UNITED.

Tottenham have agreed a club-record £85m fee for Mateus Fernandes, per ESPN and Sky Sports. United wanted him too. He chose Spurs anyway.

0202 / 06

| WHY TOTTENHAM, NOT UNITED?

Roberto De Zerbi's project won him over, and so did staying in London. United wanted certainty he wanted them first. That certainty never fully came (Sky Sports).

0303 / 06

| THE NUMBERS.

£85m, a Tottenham club record, beating the £65m paid for Dominic Solanke in 2024.

£140k a week. Age 21. Two relegations in his last two seasons, with Southampton and now West Ham.



0404 / 06

WHERE THAT WAGE ACTUALLY SITS.

Casemiro earns £350k a week. Bellingham sits near £345k (€400k). Kimmich is close behind on £322k (€384k). Fernandes starts on £140k, under half that bracket. Spurs are paying for what he could become, not what he already is.

0505 / 06

| THE DE ZERBI FIT.

Two ball-playing centre-backs draw the press, then look for a midfielder who can receive in tight space and turn it forward fast. That is Fernandes' game. He joins Maddison, Sarr and Bissouma in a midfield built to play exactly that way.

0606 / 06

| UNITED'S NEXT MOVE.

The midfield rebuild goes on without its top name. Felix Nmecha and Aurelien Tchouameni are the new names being mentioned, with Alex Scott and Carlos Baleba also in the conversation. Nothing is settled yet.

— THE TAKEAWAY

SMART BUSINESS, OR ONE UNITED SHOULD HAVE WON?

Tell us below. Follow @thearchv_ca for the daily transfer breakdown.